Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — Independent surface and structure challenge

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 2 · Big question: How can we combine collagraph relief, foil embossing, and monochromatic wash in an architectural panel?

Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How can we combine collagraph relief, foil embossing, and monochromatic wash in an architectural panel?

• Construct a textured architectural study combining card relief, embossed metal foil, and surface grain.

• Control a three-value monochromatic ink or acrylic wash to unify and deepen the recessed planes.

• Evaluate which surface combination creates the strongest illusion of weathered industrial structure.

Essential vocabulary

• collagraph: A textured relief board built by gluing varied flat and bumpy materials onto a base.

• monochromatic: Using dark, mid, and light tones of a single colour plus black and white.

• recessed: Set further back into the surface so it catches deeper shadow.

• patina: The weathered surface look that metal or stone develops over time.

• flange: The projecting rim or edge of a structural steel beam.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Assemble the multi-texture collagraph base: I glue ridged card in the background, laminated smooth girders in the midground, and an embossed foil plate at the focal joint.

Step 2: Apply dark wash into crevices: I brush dark slate wash across the seams and over the embossed foil, then gently dab the high foil ridges clean.

Step 3: Dry-brush the raised flanges: I skim a nearly dry brush of pale chrome/white across the top beam edges to complete the three-value tonal range.